

Prompt Engineering

THE COMPLETE GUIDE

A clean, text-only reference edition

Source: The App Brewery

PROMPT ENGINEERING 101 — Ingredients of a Good Prompt

1. Ask for more than 1 option.

You are a strategic business consultant with 20+ years of experience helping companies overcome growth challenges. I need your help exploring different approaches for [specific business challenge].

Please generate 4 distinctly different strategies that represent various approaches to solving this problem (not just variations of the same idea). Structure your response with clear headings for each option and a summary at the end highlighting the key differences between the approaches.

2. Assign a character to the AI.

You are Chef Marco, a passionate Italian chef with 20+ years of experience.

- You specialise in authentic regional Italian cooking with simple, fresh ingredients
- You explain techniques clearly for home cooks with limited equipment
- You suggest substitutions for hard-to-find ingredients
- You share brief stories about dishes' origins when relevant

My cooking question is: [your question]

3. Ask for a specific style of response.

I want you to respond as The Explainer - imagine you're a friendly neighbourhood expert who loves making complex things simple.

Here's how to approach our conversation:

1. Use everyday language instead of technical jargon - explain things like you would to a smart friend at a coffee shop
2. Don't give typical AI responses
3. Start your explanations with a brief real-world example or analogy
4. Keep sentences short and conversational - aim for 5th-8th grade reading level. Be like the ELI5 subreddit.
5. If you need to list information, limit it to 3-5 key points, not exhaustive lists
6. If you are unsure, rather than guessing, you can ask me clarifying questions.
7. End your response with a simple, practical takeaway. Most importantly, make sure your explanations are crystal clear while feeling like they come from a real person having a genuine conversation.

My question is: [your question]

4. Ask for a specific type/format of output.

You can also specify a well known use case, e.g. for a slide deck, a Word document, a short video explainer etc.

You are a nutrition expert specializing in meal planning. I need your help creating a 7-day healthy meal plan for someone looking to increase their protein intake while maintaining a calorie deficit.

Please format your response exactly as follows:

1. Begin with a brief introduction (max 3 sentences) explaining the nutritional approach.

2. Present the meal plan in a structured table with these exact columns:

- Day (Monday-Sunday)
- Breakfast (including calories and protein)
- Lunch (including calories and protein)
- Dinner (including calories and protein)
- Snack (including calories and protein)
- Daily Totals (sum of calories and protein)

3. After the table, include a section titled Shopping List organized by:

- Proteins
- Vegetables
- Fruits
- Grains
- Dairy/Alternatives
- Pantry Items

4. End with exactly 3 bullet points of Preparation Tips that would make following this meal plan easier.

The meal plan should total approximately 1,800 calories per day with at least 120g of protein, featuring whole foods that are widely available.

5. Chained Prompting

Guide the AI through a multi-step process for a more robust final output.

Example Scenario: Writing a blog post.

Prompt 1: Brainstorm 10 blog post titles about the benefits of meditation for busy professionals.

Prompt 2 (after choosing one): Great, I like title #4. Now, create a detailed outline for a blog post with that title. Include an introduction, three main body sections with bullet points, and a conclusion.

Prompt 3: Excellent outline. Now, write the full blog post based on this outline, with a word count of approximately 800 words and a conversational tone.

6. Few Shot Prompting

A lot of LLMs are trained on Q and A sets, which show it many examples of classifications. You can improve your prompts by following the same structure and provide a number of examples in your prompts.

Example Scenario: Writing an ad copy.

Example 1:

Our UltraComfort Camping Chair combines lightweight portability with ergonomic support. Built for outdoor adventures, it folds flat for easy packing and comes with a built-in cup holder.

Example 2:

The Nomad Trail Kettle is your perfect hiking companion. Crafted from lightweight stainless steel, it boils water fast and packs neatly into any bag.

Now write a product description for a travel backpack.

7. Be Specific and Clear

Vague prompts lead to vague answers. Instead of "Tell me about cars", ask "Compare the 2024 Honda Civic and Toyota Corolla in terms of fuel efficiency, safety ratings, and standard tech features."

8. Provide More Context

Give the AI the background information it needs to understand your request fully. The more context, the more relevant the answer.

Example Scenario: Asking for marketing advice

Example 1: Low Context Prompt

Give me a marketing strategy for my coffee shop.

Example 2: High Context Prompt

Act as a marketing consultant who specializes in helping new, local businesses. I need a marketing strategy for my coffee shop.

Here is the context:

- Business: A brand-new, independent coffee shop.
- Location: We are in a central part of Bristol, UK, with a lot of offices and a nearby university campus.
- Target Audience: Our primary customers are office workers on their lunch breaks and university students.
- Unique Selling Points: We specialize in high-quality, ethically-sourced coffee and offer a range of vegan pastries. Our atmosphere is quiet and ideal for working or studying.
- Budget: We have a very small starting budget of about £400 for the first month's marketing.
- Goal: My main goal for the next 3 months is to increase weekday foot traffic and build a base of regular customers.

Please provide a low-cost, actionable marketing plan focused on achieving this specific goal.

9. Use Delimiters

Most LLMs are trained on structured data. Common formats include XML and JSON. You can use the same formatting to make your prompts more easily understood by the AI models.

When you're including a large block of text for the AI to process (like an article or code), use delimiters like triple quotes ("""Text here"""), triple backticks (````), or XML tags (<text>Text here</text>) to clearly separate your instruction from the data.

You can also use XML delimiters to teach LLMs how to respond to your most common prompts.

For example: Your task is to categorise customer feedback into one of three categories: Bug Report, Feature Request, or Praise.

Here are some examples:

<example> The Export to PDF button isn't working. When I click it, nothing happens.

</example><output> Bug Report </output>

<example> I really love the new dashboard design! It's so much cleaner and easier to use than the old one. Great job to your team! </example><output> Praise

</output>

Now, categorise the following feedback:

<example> It would be amazing if you could add a dark mode to the interface. It would be much easier on the eyes at night. </example>

<output>

COURSE EXERCISES

Goal Breakdown

Fill in the gaps with your own information:

I have a big ambitious goal: [describe your specific goal]. Help me break this down into manageable milestones and daily actions using the Backwards Planning Method. Please:

1. Identify the minimum requirements needed to qualify for this goal
2. Break down the main goal into yearly milestones working backwards from achievement
3. Convert these milestones into monthly targets
4. Translate these into specific weekly actions
5. Suggest daily habits or tasks that would contribute to progress
6. Identify any particularly challenging obstacles and how to overcome them
7. Suggest metrics to track progress

My advantages to achieving this goal are: [insert advantages e.g. I already have a medical degree and more than 2 years work experience as a doctor]

My hindrances to achieving this goal are: [insert hindrances e.g. I don't have US citizenship, I am a UK citizen].

Linear Calendar

Fill in the gaps with your own information:

Generate a single-page HTML document of a linear timeline calendar formatted for printing on A4 paper in landscape orientation. The calendar should span the date range from [START MONTH YEAR] to [END MONTH YEAR] and be laid out as separate horizontal strips (one per month) that can be printed on a single page, cut out, and joined together into one long physical calendar.

Date Layout:

- * Display each day as a number (e.g., 1, 2, 3...) arranged left to right within each month
- * Each month should be on its own row/strip, clearly labeled as [Month YYYY]
- * Use bold visual markers (vertical dividers, spacing) to clearly define each month

Page Structure:

- * 3 rows on a single A4 landscape page, one row per month
- * Each calendar strip should be approximately 10cm (38mm) in height
- * Include cut line indicators (scissors symbol) between rows
- * Ensure day boxes align seamlessly when strips are trimmed and joined end-to-end

Visual Style:

- * Use a clean, legible font like Arial
- * Format weekends with gray shading (#f8f8f8)
- * Include [UK/US/YOUR COUNTRY] public holidays with highlighting
- * Each day box should show: day number, day abbreviation (MON, TUE, etc.), and space for notes

Output Specifications:

- * Single HTML file that can be printed to PDF at 300 DPI
- * A4 landscape orientation with 10mm margins
- * Include on-screen printing instructions
- * Ensure nothing goes off the page edges - each month must fit within the page width

PART 1 — Mastering Your Productivity

The Smart Email Drafter

This prompt helps you create well-structured emails for any situation.

Act as a professional communications assistant. Draft an email to [Recipient Name] at [Recipient's Company/Department].

The purpose of this email is to [state your objective clearly, e.g., follow up on the project proposal, request specific information, confirm meeting details].

The tone should be [e.g., formal, friendly and professional, assertive, empathetic].

Key points to include are:

- Reference our last conversation/email on [Date].
- Mention [Point 1].
- Ask for [Specific question or required action].
- State the desired deadline or next step: [e.g., I would appreciate a response by EOD Friday]. Sign off as [Your Name], [Your Title].

The Meeting Summarizer

This prompt helps you turn long meeting notes or transcripts into concise summaries with clear action items.

Please summarize the following meeting notes/transcript. Your summary should be structured into three sections:

1. Key Decisions Made: (List the main conclusions reached).
2. Action Items: (Use a table with columns for 'Task', 'Owner', and 'Deadline').
3. Open Questions: (List any topics that require further discussion).

Here is the text: [Paste your meeting notes or transcript here]

The Task Prioritizer

When you're overwhelmed with tasks, use this prompt to get a clear, logical plan.

I need to prioritize my tasks for today. My main goal is [Your primary objective, e.g., to prepare for the client presentation]. Here is my to-do list: [List all your tasks]. Please organize these tasks using the Eisenhower Matrix (Urgent/Important). Provide the output as a four-quadrant list.

Add Your Own

Refine your own prompts based on your needs and exploration and catalogue them here.

[Space for your own prompt template]

PART 2 — Enhancing Learning

The Concept Explainer

This prompt helps you break down any complex idea into simple, understandable terms.

Explain the concept of [insert complex topic, e.g., blockchain, general relativity, machine learning] to me. Assume I am a [target audience, e.g., a high school student, a marketing manager with no tech background, a curious 10-year-old]. Use analogies and simple language, and avoid jargon where possible.

The Study Planner

This prompt helps you create a structured learning plan for any new skill or subject you want to tackle.

I want to learn [skill or subject, e.g., Python programming for data analysis, conversational Spanish]. I can dedicate [number] hours per week. Create a [duration, e.g., 4-week] study plan for me. The plan should include:

- Weekly topics to cover.
- Recommended resources (e.g., free online courses, books, websites).
- A small project or practice exercise for each week to test my knowledge.

The Key Takeaway Extractor

This prompt helps you get the essence of any long article, document, or book without reading the whole thing.

Read the following text and extract the 5 most important takeaways. For each takeaway, provide a one-sentence summary. The intended audience for this summary is a [e.g., busy executive, college student]. Text: [Paste the article or text here]

YouTube Watcher

This prompt will help you extract the main learning points from a YouTube video without you having to watch it.

Please watch (or read the transcript of) this YouTube video [INSERT VIDEO URL] and provide a concise summary of the main learning points. Focus on the key ideas, actionable insights, or step-by-step methods the speaker shares. Avoid filler, anecdotes, or repetition. Present the output as a clear, structured bullet-point list with time stamps to review. If relevant, group the points under short sub-headings for clarity.

Example Output Format:

- Core Idea 1: [short explanation]
- Actionable Steps:
- Step 1

The Language Tutor

This prompt gives you a live interactive language tutor.

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[Speak this prompt] You are my personal language tutor. I am learning [TARGET LANGUAGE] at a [BEGINNER / INTERMEDIATE / ADVANCED] level. Please speak with me slowly and clearly, correct my mistakes in grammar and vocabulary. Mix conversation practice with short teaching moments – ask me questions, encourage me to respond in the language I'm learning, and only switch to English if I'm really stuck.
```

You need to open ChatGPT Voice in the mobile app.

The Flash Card Maker

This prompt helps you generate flash cards that are ready to load into Anki to test yourself on any information.

```
You are an expert educator skilled at creating effective flashcards. From the following content, generate high-quality flashcards in Question-Answer format.
```

```
Guidelines:
```

- Output in tab-separated format (Q -> A). Each line = one flashcard.
- No extra formatting, labels, or numbering. Just: Question<TAB>Answer (where <TAB> means a literal tab character).
- Phrase questions so they are clear, testable, and concise.
- Ensure answers are accurate, complete, but not overly verbose.
- Vary the flashcard types: Definition (What is X?), Application (How does X work? Why does Y happen?), Comparison (What's the difference between X and Y?), Example-based (Give an example of X).
- Break down long or complex content into multiple smaller cards.
- Exclude filler, anecdotes, or redundant details.

```
Content to convert into flashcards:
```

```
[PASTE CONTENT HERE]
```

Then take the content that is generated and paste it into a plain text editor (e.g. Notepad, VSCode, Cursor). Save the file with a .txt extension (e.g. flashcards.txt). Now open Anki and create a new deck, click Import file and navigate to the flashcards.txt file, select the deck you want to import these flash cards into and hit the Import button.

Add Your Own

Refine your own prompts based on your needs and exploration and catalogue them here.

```
[Space for your own prompt template]
```

PART 3 — Excelling at Work

The Meeting Summariser

This prompt will summarise the key decisions and action points of a meeting. I recommend using Google Gemini if you already have the transcript, meeting video, or audio file. Otherwise, use ChatGPT record mode.

You are an expert business analyst. Your task is to generate a clear and professional summary of the following meeting.

Input:

- If a transcript is provided, use it directly.
- If only a video or audio link is provided, transcribe the content first, then analyse it.

Output Format:

1. Key Decisions - List what was agreed upon.
2. Action Items - Assign responsibilities (who is responsible) and note deadlines if mentioned.
3. Open Questions / Unresolved Issues - Highlight points requiring follow-up.
4. General Summary - A concise overview of the meeting's purpose, main topics, and context.

Guidelines:

- Write in bullet-point form for clarity.
- Use professional, neutral language.
- Exclude small talk, filler, and irrelevant details.
- If information is missing (e.g., speaker names, deadlines), note it as "Not specified".
- If the audio/video is unclear or incomplete, summarise based on what is available.

The Checklist Creator

This prompt will create an actionable checklist to help you organise your work.

I want you to act as a checklist creator. Please create a clear, structured checklist for [insert topic, task, or project].

The checklist should be:

- Organized into logical sections (if relevant).
- Action-oriented, with each item starting with a verb.
- Concise but detailed enough to be actionable.
- Presented in a clean, bullet-point or checkbox format that I can easily copy or use in a tool like Notion, Excel, or an app.
- Optional: Include a short description or example for each item to clarify what success looks like.

The Persuasion Artist

This prompt will create a persuasive argument for you to use at work.

I need to argue my case at work. Please help me structure a persuasive argument. I'll give you the situation, my position, and the audience. Your task is to:

1. Identify the key points I should emphasize.
2. Anticipate possible counterarguments and prepare strong rebuttals.
3. Suggest persuasive language and framing that fits a professional workplace setting.
4. Provide a clear structure (e.g., opening statement, main points, conclusion/call-to-action) that I can use in an email, meeting, or presentation.
5. Give me a short version (2-3 sentences) for quick discussions and a longer version (2-3 paragraphs) for formal communication.

Here's my situation: [insert details here]. My position: [position]. My audience: [audience].

The \$Million Consultant

This prompt gives you a free consultant to take a look at your problems and generate solution frameworks.

You are a senior strategy consultant trained in the style of McKinsey, BCG, and Bain. I will present you with a problem, and your job is to:

1. Diagnose the situation - ask clarifying questions if needed and summarize the core challenge.
2. Provide at least 2 different strategic frameworks (e.g., MECE breakdowns, 2x2 matrices, value-driver trees, Porter's Five Forces, growth-share matrix, etc.) to structure and analyze the problem.
3. Apply each framework to my problem step by step, showing how it helps me think about root causes, trade-offs, and possible solutions.
4. Synthesize recommendations into 2-3 clear, actionable paths forward, highlighting risks and benefits.
5. Keep your reasoning structured, concise, and professional (as if presenting slides to an executive team).

Here's my problem: [insert your problem here].

The Idea Generator

This prompt helps you brainstorm fresh ideas for any project or context.

I am working on [project, e.g., a new marketing campaign, a blog, a YouTube channel].

The target audience is [describe audience, e.g., young professionals interested in sustainable living].

Generate [number] creative ideas for [what you need, e.g., blog post titles, campaign slogans, video concepts].

For each idea, provide a brief description.

The Interview Coach

This prompt can help you ace interviews by peppering you with questions and giving you timely feedback. I recommend using ChatGPT Voice with this prompt.

I want you to act as my interview coach. Please conduct a realistic mock interview for the role of [job title] at [company/industry]. Ask me questions one at a time, just like in a real interview. Cover a mix of:

- Common behavioral questions (e.g., teamwork, conflict, leadership, problem-solving).
- Role-specific technical or domain knowledge questions.
- Situational/what-would-you-do questions.
- Closing questions (e.g., why I want the role, what I'd bring to the team).

After each of my answers, give me structured feedback with:

1. Strengths in my response.
2. Areas to improve.
3. A suggested stronger version of my answer (if needed).

At the end, summarize my overall performance and key points to work on. Keep the tone professional but encouraging. Start now with your first question.

The Tone Adjuster

This prompt helps you instantly rewrite text to fit the perfect tone for your audience.

Rewrite the following text to make it sound more [desired tone, e.g., persuasive, empathetic, confident, concise and professional].

Original Text: [Paste your text here]

The Proofreader and Editor

This prompt helps you go beyond a simple spell-check to improve clarity, flow, and impact.

Please proofread the following text. Correct any spelling, grammar, and punctuation errors. In addition, suggest improvements to enhance clarity, conciseness, and overall readability.

Provide the revised text. Text: [Paste your text here]

The Content Starter

When you're overwhelmed with tasks, use this prompt to get a clear, logical plan.

I need to prioritize my tasks for today. My main goal is [Your primary objective, e.g., to prepare for the client presentation]. Here is my to-do list: [List all your tasks]. Please organize these tasks using the Eisenhower Matrix (Urgent/Important). Provide the output as a four-quadrant list.

The Difficult Conversation Planner

This prompt helps you structure your thoughts and prepare key talking points for challenging discussions.

I need to have a difficult conversation with [Person, e.g., my manager, my team member] about [Topic, e.g., my workload, their performance, a project delay]. Help me structure the conversation. Provide key talking points that are clear, constructive, and professional. My goal is to [state your desired outcome].

The Angle Finder

This prompt helps you explore a topic from multiple perspectives to create unique content.

I need to write about [Topic, e.g., the future of remote work]. Give me 5 different angles or perspectives to approach this topic from. The angles should be:

1. Technological
2. Sociological/Cultural
3. Economic
4. Psychological (individual well-being)
5. A contrarian or controversial view.

The Strategic Frameworks Applicator

This prompt helps you apply established business and thinking models to your problems.

I am developing a [product/business idea, e.g., a mobile app for local gardeners]. Please perform a SWOT analysis (Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, Threats) for this idea. Present the output in four distinct lists.

The Pro-Con Analyst

This prompt helps you get a balanced view of any major decision you're facing.

I am considering [Decision, e.g., accepting a new job offer, moving to a new city, buying a new car].

Act as a decision-making consultant and create a detailed table of pros and cons.

Consider factors like:

- Financial implications
- Impact on work-life balance
- Long-term opportunities
- Personal happiness and stress

The Second Brain Sounding Board

This prompt helps you talk through a problem to see it from a new perspective.

Act as a critical thinking partner. I am facing a problem: [Describe your problem in detail]. Ask me 5 probing questions that will help me think through this problem more deeply and identify potential solutions I may have overlooked.

Add Your Own

Refine your own prompts based on your needs and exploration and catalogue them here.

[Space for your own prompt template]

PART 6 — Improving Everyday Life

The Free Therapist

This prompt helps you use ChatGPT Voice as a free therapist.

[Speak:] I'd like you to act as a supportive therapist. Please listen actively, ask thoughtful and gentle follow-up questions, and give me time to reflect before offering insights. Use an empathetic, non-judgmental tone. Don't just give quick solutions - help me explore my feelings, patterns, and possible coping strategies. If I get stuck, guide me with open-ended questions.

The Recipe Generator

This prompt helps you get meal ideas based on what you have and your dietary needs. (Try uploading an image of your fridge.)

I need a recipe for [dinner/lunch/breakfast] tonight. I have the following ingredients: [list ingredients]. I have [e.g., 30 minutes] to cook. My dietary restrictions are [e.g., gluten-free, vegetarian]. Please provide a simple, step-by-step recipe.

The Fitness & Workout Planner

This prompt helps you create a personalized workout plan to meet your fitness goals.

Create a [number]-day workout plan for me. My primary goal is [e.g., to build muscle, lose weight, improve cardiovascular health]. I have access to [list available equipment, e.g., dumbbells, resistance bands, or just my bodyweight]. I am at a [beginner/intermediate/advanced] fitness level. The plan should include warm-ups and cool-downs.

The Coupon Finder

This prompt helps you find active discount codes for shopping online.

Act as a smart shopping assistant. Search the web for currently valid and active discount or promo codes for [RETAILER NAME]. I need codes that work today for online checkout (not expired or region-locked). If possible, provide multiple options, list the discount amount (percentage or fixed), and include any conditions (e.g., minimum spend, new customers only). Prioritize the most reliable and highest-value codes.

The Personal Travel Agent

This prompt takes care of the entire holiday planning process. I recommend using ChatGPT Agent.

You are my expert travel planner. Plan a complete holiday for me including:

1. Flights - realistic flight options (times, airlines, airports, costs).
2. Accommodation - 2-3 options at different budget levels (budget, mid-range, luxury).
3. Itinerary - a day-by-day plan with sightseeing, cultural activities, relaxation, and food recommendations.
4. Packing list - tailored to the destination, season, and activities.
5. Travel tips - include local customs, transport, safety tips, and estimated daily budget.

Here are my details:

- Travel dates: [insert dates or note if flexible]
- Departure city + preferred airports: [insert city + airports]
- Destination(s): [insert destination(s) or ask for suggestions]
- Preferred travel style: [adventurous / relaxed / luxury / budget / family-friendly / etc.]
- Main interests: [nature / food / history / shopping / nightlife / culture / beaches / etc.]
- Restrictions or special needs: [dietary restrictions, pregnancy, mobility, etc.]

Format the answer in clear sections with headings and finish with a concise summary table of the trip.

The Handyman

This prompt helps you fix small plumbing or DIY issues at home. I recommend using ChatGPT voice for turn-by-turn advice.

[Paste in and adjust:] Act as my experienced handyman. I have this issue [Insert Issue], and you will guide me step by step on how to troubleshoot and fix it safely. Start by asking me clarifying questions to understand the exact problem, tools I have available, and my skill level. Then explain what's going on in simple terms, provide clear instructions, and suggest alternative solutions if needed. Point out any safety precautions, materials, or tools required.

The Personal Dietician

This prompt helps you create a professional meal plan for any dietary or health goal you have.

You are a professional dietitian. Please create a detailed meal plan for me.

- Type of diet/dietary restrictions: [insert here, e.g., vegetarian, gluten-free, Mediterranean, keto, pregnancy-safe, etc.]
- Health goals: [insert here, e.g., weight loss, muscle gain, balanced nutrition, improve energy levels, manage blood sugar, etc.]

The plan should:

1. Be structured day by day (e.g., 7-day plan).
2. Include breakfast, lunch, dinner, and 1-2 snacks each day.
3. Provide portion guidance and approximate calorie/macronutrient breakdown per meal if possible.
4. Suggest whole food ingredients and avoid highly processed foods.
5. Be practical and realistic for home cooking.
6. Include variety across the days to prevent repetition.
7. Optionally, add a shopping list at the end.

Dictate and Punctuate

Dictate large blocks of text, like letters and emails, without interruption or needing punctuation. I recommend using ChatGPT dictation, along with a backup voice recording, then using this prompt to clean it up.

You are my transcription assistant. I will paste in a raw transcript or dictation. Please clean it up into well-written prose with correct punctuation, capitalization, and paragraph breaks. Keep my original meaning and tone intact, but remove filler words, hesitations, and repeated phrases. Do not add extra commentary or change the meaning. Format the result so it reads as natural, polished writing.

Live Interpreter

This prompt helps you communicate with someone who does not speak your language. I recommend using ChatGPT voice.

You are my live interpreter. When you hear [Language A], immediately translate it to [Language B]. When you hear [Language B], immediately translate it to [Language A]. You are interpreting for people talking face-to-face. Do not add commentary or explanations, do not respond - just translate and speak the target language every time.

Add Your Own

Refine your own prompts based on your needs and exploration and catalogue them here.

[Space for your own prompt template]

PART 7 — For Technical & Coding Tasks

The Function Generator

This prompt helps you generate self-contained functions and explains the code that it writes.

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Write a function in [Programming Language, e.g., Python] that takes [function inputs, e.g., a list of strings] and [function purpose, e.g., returns a new list with all strings converted to uppercase]. Add comments to explain the code step by step.
```

The Code Debugger

This prompt helps you find and explain errors in a piece of code.

```
I am getting an error in my [Programming Language] code. The error is [paste the error message]. Here is the code that is causing the problem: [Paste your code snippet here]
```

The Code Explainer

This prompt helps you read and understand a snippet of code. You can also link to your coding application in ChatGPT.

```
You are my coding explainer. I will give you some code, and you will:  
1. Explain in plain English what the code does, step by step.  
2. Highlight the purpose of each key part (functions, variables, classes, loops, etc.).  
3. Point out any potential pitfalls, edge cases, or things to watch out for.  
Here's the code: [Paste your code snippet here or link to VSCode tab in ChatGPT].
```

The Regex Creator

This prompt helps you generate complex regular expressions from a plain English description.

```
Create a regular expression (regex) that can be used to validate a [what you want to validate, e.g., a strong password that must contain at least 8 characters, one uppercase letter, one lowercase letter, one number, and one special character].
```

The Code Review

This prompt gives you a free senior developer to review and critique your code.

Simulate a code review by a senior engineer.
Goals: correctness, readability, performance, security, testability, and maintainability.
Constraints: keep the existing public API stable; no framework changes.
Deliverables:
1) High-level summary (what's good / risky),
2) Concrete issues with code quotes/line refs,
3) Actionable fixes (show diffs or pseudocode),
4) Priority labels [P0/P1/P2] and impact [low/med/high],
5) A 10-15 line refactor plan,
6) 3-5 unit tests (or property tests) that would catch current/future bugs.
Be direct, specific, and concise, don't flatter me. Avoid bikeshedding.
[Paste your code]

The Doc Generator

Writing docs is a pain - use this prompt to get AI to do it for you.

Act as a senior technical writer. Generate clear, developer-friendly documentation for the following project/code.

Context:

- Audience: [new contributors / internal team / open-source developers / end users]
- Tech stack: [Node.js + React, PostgreSQL, Docker, etc.]
- Style: [concise, example-driven, friendly, professional]

Tasks:

1. Executive summary (1-2 paras: what it is, why it exists)
2. Architecture overview (diagram in text, modules/components, flow)
3. Setup guide (prereqs, install, configure, run, test)
4. Usage guide (examples, CLI/API endpoints, screenshots if relevant)
5. Configuration (env vars, config files, secrets handling)
6. Testing (how to run tests, test strategy, coverage)
7. Deployment (local, staging, production; CI/CD notes)
8. Contributing guide (branching, PRs, lint/test rules)
9. FAQ & Troubleshooting (common errors, fixes)
10. License and credits

Deliverable:

- Well-structured Markdown (README.md) with headings, subheadings, fenced code blocks, tables if needed.
- Use language suitable for [junior devs / senior devs / external contributors].

Angela Bot

This prompt gives you analogies to explain coding concepts in the style of Angela Yu, so you can learn anything you want.

Explain the concept of [insert programming topic, e.g. recursion / APIs / closures / Docker] in the style of Dr. Angela Yu. Make sure you add lots of real-life analogies and break things down step by step as if teaching a total beginner.

The Technical Planner

This prompt helps you plan your coding projects.

You are my technical project planner. I will give you a project idea, and you will help me turn it into a detailed, actionable plan.

For the project idea I give you, do the following:

1. Clarify the Vision: Restate my idea in your own words, highlight any missing details, and ask me 3-5 clarifying questions to better define the project.
2. Define Outcomes: Write a clear project goal, success criteria, and 2-3 user stories that show what a user should be able to do when the project is complete.
3. Break Down Features: List the main features, group them into epics, and identify the MVP (minimum viable product) vs. nice-to-have features.
4. Choose Tech Stack: Suggest an appropriate tech stack (frontend, backend, database, deployment) and explain why it's a good fit.
5. Plan Architecture: Sketch a high-level architecture (components, APIs, data flows) and describe how the pieces fit together.
6. Create a Timeline: Break work into phases (MVP, polish, launch) and suggest a rough timeline with priorities.
7. List Risks & Unknowns: Point out potential challenges, bottlenecks, or open questions I need to research.

Format your answer in a clean, structured way (use headings, bullet points, and tables where helpful).

My project idea is: [insert your project idea here]

1. The Prompt to Prompt

This prompt helps generate a coding prompt.

I want to build a project called [Project Name].
It will be a [1 sentence description].
Here are the features: [Bullet point list of features].
Ask me clarifying questions and check your assumptions. DO NOT BUILD ANYTHING YET.

2a. The AI Recommended Tech Stack

This prompt helps you narrow down the tech stack using recommendations from the AI. (For non-technical users.)

Act as a senior solutions architect. Recommend [3-5] different tech stacks to build this project. For each option, explain in plain English (no jargon) what it includes (front end, back end, database, hosting), why it's a good fit for my situation, the main trade-offs, and rough build/time. Use simple analogies a non-technical stakeholder would understand. Finish with a comparison table and a clear recommendation. DO NOT WRITE ANY CODE YET.

2b. The Work with AI Tech Stack

This prompt helps you define the tech stack with clarifying questions from the AI. (For experienced programmers.)

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Act as a senior solutions architect. Help me choose the optimal tech stack through a structured, iterative conversation. Assume I'm an experienced developer. Be concise, opinionated, and practical. Start by asking up to 10 high-leverage questions to close critical unknowns. - Offer suggested defaults in [brackets] I can accept quickly. Propose 3-5 stack options. DO NOT WRITE ANY CODE YET.
```

2c. The Simple Tech Stack

This prompt helps you create a project using a standard and simple front-end tech stack.

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I want this to be a vanilla JS, HTML, CSS project that is front-end only. It should use localStorage for data storage. I'm happy to use React via CDN if necessary and the Canvas API for the graphics. Now ask me any clarifying questions you have. DO NOT WRITE ANY CODE YET.
```

3. The Coding Prompt

This prompt helps you create a prompt that will generate the project code after steps 1 and 2. It must be used in the same chat (context). I recommend picking the best prompt from the result and giving it to the Claude web interface.

```
Now generate 2 versions of prompts to take all of the above into account so I can use it to generate the code for the project. DO NOT WRITE ANY CODE.
```

Add Your Own

Refine your own prompts based on your needs and exploration and catalogue them here.

```
[Space for your own prompt template]
```

PART 8 — Vibe-Coding Commandments

1. I will try to make my first prompt as well-planned and well thought-out as possible.

Remember: garbage in, garbage out. Something a lot of devs underestimate when they first start using AI is how important the initial context is. Think of it like giving requirements to a junior dev: if you're vague, you'll get something that technically "works" but misses half of what you had in mind. With AI, the model builds its whole answer around the first chunk of information you give it. If that's fuzzy, the entire response gets skewed.

I recommend using thinking models (GPT-5 Thinking, Gemini 2.5 Pro, or Claude Opus) to refine your thinking before you even start to code anything.

2. I will not let AI compliment me.

Most of the AI companies out there have tuned their AIs to be excessively sycophantic. If you think about it, it makes sense - we all like working with people who think we're great. But this is a human bug; don't be tempted into this trap, as it will make your work far lower in quality and limit the capabilities of the AI. Adding a system prompt telling the AI to "never compliment me or my ideas" doesn't work well, since your prompts won't supersede the AI company's system prompts. Instead, try these options:

- Ask for 2 proposals from the AI. Then ask the AI to analyse the two options and pick the better one. The AI is not programmed to be sycophantic about its own ideas.
- Ask the AI to generate a plan and then ask it to critique the plan. You can do this multiple times, and it will result in a much better plan while avoiding the AI getting confused.

3. I will not use obscure tech stacks.

Imagine the AI only learnt how to code by looking at all the publicly available codebases on the internet and the accessible documentation. If you try to use some obscure framework that was developed yesterday with zero publicly available documentation, you will have a very bad time vibe coding.

Instead, choose a tech stack that has been utilised to death - e.g. React, Postgres, PHP, AWS. Ask the AI what the most popular technologies are for your particular idea or project. This is not the place to express individuality or try to vibe-code using the latest obscure framework.

- Look at the most popular online coding courses for a particular field and see what technologies they teach - it will usually feature the most popular tech stacks.
- Alternatively, just ask the AI, e.g. "I want to build an iOS app [describe app] - what is the best tech stack to use for this application?"

4. I will learn Git first.

When AI generates code it will always require refinement. If you think you can enter a prompt and out comes a completed project, you should not even start vibe coding. There will be many hours of back and forth with the AI to tweak the code and add features incrementally. When AI modifies an existing codebase, it does not know what it just did - if you ask it to simply undo what it did, you will not get back to the previous codebase. This is why, even if you don't master programming, you need to at least understand how to use Git and version control. Git allows you to branch out, seamlessly roll back, or review various code points like a programming time machine. It also helps prevent accidentally leaking sensitive information like API keys and passwords.

- Complete a Git, GitHub, and Version Control module before you even start vibe coding.

- Commit every small change - don't let changes pile up.

5. I will break large features into smaller chunks.

Similar to when we code in person, the success of large projects relies on a key software engineering skill - how to break down a project. Unfortunately, when it comes to vibe coding, this skill is the difference between a project that works and a project that is abandoned. Not only do you have to write good prompts, you also need to know how to break a project down into features and features into small components. Don't give the AI a prompt like "build a flash card app" unless it's something super generic - you will need to break things down.

- Break down a project into user stories, features, and epics.
- You can get any thinking AI model to help you do this.
- Don't give the AI a huge prompt; limit the scope of the work. Just because you included all the feature details in your prompt does not mean the AI can execute on all of it.

6. I will avoid context bloat.

The context window will be different depending on which model you use. However, they will all have a limit. When you go over this size (from too many back-and-forths with the AI), it will start losing context - it will forget what you told it before, start doing things differently from what you previously specified, or lose track of the project entirely.

To prevent this, follow a couple of best practices:

- Craft your prompts - use a thinking model to help you refine each prompt you give your coding AI. Don't just type something and let the AI guess what you mean.
- When the context window gets large, close it and start a new one. Mention what you were working on, the files involved, and the components to model on.
- Use file references instead of pasting code to save on tokens, e.g. `@src/components/layout/index.ts`

7. I will review the thought process before letting the AI write any code.

It's very tempting to let the AI just get on with it. But from experience, this will lead to a lot of terrible code, hallucinations, and nothing close to what you asked for. It's easy enough to use Git to go back to a previous codebase, but it's annoying and inefficient. The best thing to do is to review what the AI is about to do before it does it - let it think out loud so you can spot weird assumptions or strange approaches before it inserts code across 20 different files.

- Ask the AI to "Explain your approach step-by-step before writing any code."
- Add the line "DO NOT CHANGE ANYTHING I DID NOT ASK FOR, JUST DO ONLY WHAT I TOLD YOU" after each prompt to reduce unhelpful, random code changes. Yes, the all-caps helps.

8. I will not get stuck on fixing errors and bugs.

When you start vibe coding for long enough, you will get frustrated by the number of errors, bugs, and unrequested changes the AI produces. Rather than going down a rabbit hole of telling it "you did bad" or "why won't it run", follow this error-solving strategy:

- Give the AI 3 chances. Describe the issue, provide any error messages, and add context about the code lines/files causing the error. After 3 chances, if it hasn't solved it, it will likely never solve it - abandon this path.
- Roll back to the point before you started building this feature (or aspect of it) and re-try with a

better-designed prompt. The smaller you break down your project, the easier this process will be.

9. I will set constraints for the AI.

The AI cannot read your mind, so if you want it to do a good job you need to set it up to succeed. There are many ways of setting constraints. Here are some to research and think about:

- Use a tool like gitingest.com to make your codebase more easily understood by LLMs rather than pasting whole swaths of code.
- Use Cursor rules to set a system prompt based on best practices for your tech stack (cursor.directory has ready-made ones).
- Use the Context7 MCP to provide up-to-date documentation for the frameworks you are using.
- Use a component library like 21.dev to give the AI LLM-readable components and keep your UI design consistent.
- Always run `/init` when you start a new Claude Code project and maintain your `CLAUDE.md` file religiously.

10. I will regularly review the code the AI has written, and definitely before I deploy anything to production.

Because the AI learnt how to code from all the publicly available codebases on the internet, it does not really care about best practice, security, maintainability, or code quality - there is a lot of junk code out there. As a vibe coder, one of the biggest dangers is playing with fire: insecure databases that leak user passwords, API keys left in plain sight, applications vulnerable to simple attacks. Ideally you'd learn programming systematically and review all the AI's code yourself, but if that's not realistic yet, use these steps to mitigate the risks:

- Before you commit any code, use a thinking model to review the changes for security, performance, and maintainability issues. Ask it to spot bad coding practices and check adherence to your (or your company's) style guidelines.
- "Alloying" is a good idea here - take something one model (e.g. Claude) coded up and have another model (e.g. Gemini) review it, then take that review to a third model (e.g. ChatGPT) to suggest further improvements.

PART 9 — Role-Playing & Persona-Based Prompts

The Expert Persona

This is the most common and powerful role-playing technique.

Act as an expert [role, e.g., SEO strategist, financial advisor, senior software architect]. I need your advice on [your situation or question]. Please provide a detailed, expert-level response based on industry best practices.

The Socratic Opponent

Use this to challenge your own ideas and find weaknesses in your arguments.

Act as a critical thinker and Socratic debater. My hypothesis is that [state your argument or idea]. Your goal is to challenge my assumptions and find flaws in my logic. Please ask me challenging questions and point out potential weaknesses.

The Creative Muse

Use a persona to inspire creativity from a specific point of view.

I want you to act as [famous creative person, e.g., Steve Jobs, David Ogilvy, Wes Anderson]. I am developing a [product/project, e.g., a new smartphone, an advertising campaign, a short film]. Based on your persona's principles, what advice would you give me?

Add Your Own

Refine your own prompts based on your needs and exploration and catalogue them here.

[Space for your own prompt template]

PART 10 — Advanced Techniques: Chaining & Formatting

Chained Prompting

Guide the AI through a multi-step process for a more robust final output.

Example Scenario: Writing a blog post.

Prompt 1: Brainstorm 10 blog post titles about the benefits of meditation for busy professionals.

Prompt 2 (after choosing one): Great, I like title #4. Now, create a detailed outline for a blog post with that title. Include an introduction, three main body sections with bullet points, and a conclusion.

Prompt 3: Excellent outline. Now, write the full blog post based on this outline, with a word count of approximately 800 words and a conversational tone.

Specific Output Formatting

Tell the AI exactly how you want the information presented.

Prompt Templates:

- Please provide the output as a Markdown table.
- Format the response as a JSON object with the following keys: key1, key2, key3.
- Present the information as a simple, numbered list.
- Give me the output in HTML format for a simple webpage.

Useful AI Tools and Agents

Part 1 — Core tools with multi-purpose functionality

- 1 OpenAI's ChatGPT
- 2 Anthropic's Claude
- 3 Google Gemini
- 4 X's Grok

Part 2 — AI Tools/agents with specific use-cases

There are usually multiple competing tools; the following are the best performing for each use-case.

Video Generation	Veo3 via Google Flow
Image Generation	4o Image generation via ChatGPT
Text to Speech	ElevenLabs
Speech to Text	OpenAI Whisper API via ChatGPT Dictation
AI Audio Editing	Adobe Podcast
AI Video Editing	CapCut
Music Generation	Suno
Slide Generation	Canva AI
Conversational AI	Sesame AI
Code Editing	Cursor
Coding	Claude Code
Medical Research	Consensus